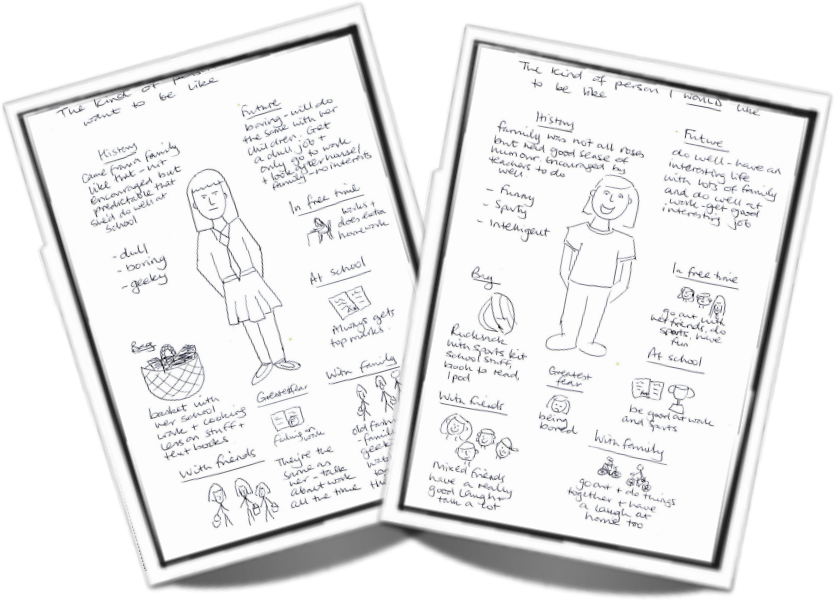
DRAWING THE IDEAL SELF



PROMPT SHEET

A PERSONAL CONSTRUCT PSYCHOLOGY TECHNIQUE TO EXPLORE SELF-ESTEEM

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EQUIPMENT

Three sheets of plain paper (A4 is a good size) and black pen.

INSTRUCTIONS

Throughout the task, the child does the drawings and you will write the labels. This ensures that the labels are recorded accurately. Detailed instructions and information about this technique (including an example and details of how to report Drawing the Ideal Self) and in the handbook, Drawing the Ideal Self: A Personal Construct Technique to Explore Self Esteem which can be downloaded from my website www.drawingtheidealself.co.uk .

Part 1: Drawing the kind of person you would not like to be like

The person
Think about the kind of person you would not like to be like. This is not a real person but it could be made up of various people you have known. Make a quick sketch of this person in the middle of the page.

How would you describe this person? What kind of a person are they? Tell me three things about what he/she is like? Write the labels for the client next to the sketch.

The bag
This person goes out to school or college each day and takes his/her bag. What kind of a bag would that be and what would be inside it? Sketch and label the items.

The birthday present
What would this person like for his/her birthday? Sketch and label the present.

With family
How would this person get on with his/her family? Sketch and write descriptions.

With friends
How would this person get on with his/her friends? Sketch and write descriptions.

At school
How would this person get on at school? Sketch and write descriptions.

What would be this person's greatest fear in life?
Everyone is afraid of something. What would this person be afraid of? Sketch and write descriptions.

History
How did this person come to be like this? What is his/her history? Was he/her always like this from birth or did he/she become like this? What happened to him/her? Write what the child says.

Future
What will this person's future be like? What will become of him/her? Write what the child says.

Part 2: Drawing the kind of person you would like to be like

Using the same instructions as for Part 1 above, make a further labelled drawing about *the kind of person you would like to be like*.

Part 3: Mapping development and movement towards the person he/she wants to be like

Place the two drawings on the table, with the first on the left. Place a piece of paper in a landscape position on the table in between the drawings and draw a horizontal line half way down the page. The line should be the length of the page, joining the two pictures, as shown below.

Ask the child to mark where he/she would rate him/herself at various points in time and label each point. The most essential points are *where he/she would say he/she is now* and *where he/she would like to be (ideal self).* It may be helpful to check *the point they would settle for* (is ideal the only option?) A completed rating might look like the one shown below.

Mapping development over time
Map where the child would rate him/herself at different points in time. (E.g. Where were you as a child of 5? What about when you started secondary school?) Label each point. Ask about the differences between points in time.

How did you get there?
Look at differences between points (e.g. between now and an earlier point). Ask the child for the reasons for these changes. How come you moved from here to here? What was happening to help you move up/what made you move down? This is especially useful for exploring any large changes.

How could you move towards your ideal?
Ask for three things others can do to help the child move from where they are now to their ideal rating point. Ask for three things the child could do to help them get to their ideal point.

Mapping different views of the child
Where would other people say you were along this line? Why would they say that? (E.g. Where would your mum say you were? What about your sister? Where

would your friend say you were?) Ask about the differences in views. What effects do the various views have on the child?

Part 4: Discussion

The final step in the process is to consider what sense the work makes to you and to discuss that with the child. It is vital to this approach that you do not miss this part out: the whole approach is designed to explore the child's view and you cannot be certain that the child feels their views are represented unless you check it out with them.

If the aim is to report back to other people on the child's views, this needs to be discussed with the child, outlining what how you will present the explanation and information and whether the pictures can be shown to other people. It is good practice to offer to copy the pictures for the child but be cautious about when they will take them away and to whom they might be shown. It may be better to hold on to the copies until it is explained to other people so that they make sense when they are viewed.

Get in touch

Contact me for more information or with questions via my website or directly at drawingtheidealself@icloud.com